

0.0.1 Sakka's Questions (excerpt)

sakkapañhasuttaṃ
(excerpt)

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| <p>1. “Do you, O Ruler of the devas, recall having asked these questions of other samanas and brahmanas?”</p> | <p>abhiḥjānāsi no tvam devānaminda, ime pañhe aññe samaṇabrāhmaṇe pucchitā”ti.</p> |
| <p>2. “I do recall, O Bhante, having asked these questions of other samanas and brahmanas.”</p> | <p>“abhiḥjānāmaham bhante, ime pañhe aññe samaṇabrāhmaṇe pucchitā”ti.</p> |
| <p>3. “But, O Ruler of the devas, if it is not troublesome for you, speak as to how they answered.”</p> | <p>“yathākathaṃ pana te devānaminda byākamsu, sace te agaru bhāsassū”ti.</p> |
| <p>4. “It is not troublesome for me, O Bhante, of where the Auspicious One is seated or someone like the Auspicious One.”</p> | <p>“na kho me bhante, garu yatthassa bhagavā nisinno bhagavantarūpo vā”ti.</p> |
| <p>5. “Well then, O Ruler of the devas, speak.”</p> | <p>“tena hi devānaminda bhāsassū”ti.</p> |

6. Those who, O Bhante, that I conceived to be “Samanas and brahmanas who are forest dwellers in secluded resting places,” to them I approached. Having approached, I asked these questions. They were not able to answer the questions asked. Being unable to answer, they asked me a question in return: “What is your name venerable sir?” When asked, I answer to them: “I, Dear sir, am Sakka, Ruler of the devas.” They then asked a further question of me: “But having done what kamma, O venerable sir, was it possible for you to attain this rulership of the devas?” To them I taught the dhamma as I have heard and learned it. They surely became pleased with just that much [rejoicing]: “We have seen Sakka, Ruler of the devas and he has answered the questions we asked him.” “Those on the other hand become my disci-

“ye svāhaṃ¹ bhante, smaññāmi samaṇa-brāhmaṇā ārañṇakā pantasenāsanā’ti, tyāhaṃ upasaṅka-mitvā ime pañhe pucchāmi. te mayā puṭṭhā na sampāyanti, asampāyantā mamaṃ yeva paṭipucchanti’ ko nāmo āyasmā?’ti. tesāhaṃ puṭṭho byākāromi: “ahaṃ kho mārisa, sakko devānamindo’ti. te mamaṃ yeva uttarim paṭipucchanti ‘kiṃ paṇāyasmā devānaminda kammaṃ katvā imaṃ ṭhānaṃ patto’ti. tesāhaṃ ya-thāsutaṃ yathāpa-riyattaṃ dhammaṃ desemi. te tāvata-keneva attamanā honti ‘sakko ca no devānamindo diṭṭho yañca no apucchimha tañca no

ples, instead of I being theirs. But I, O Bhante, am a disciple of the Auspicious One, a stream-enterer, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.”

7. “Do you recall, O Ruler of the devas, having gained such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness in the past from here?”

8. “I do recall, O Bhante, having gained such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness in the past from here.”

9. “But you, O Ruler of the devas, in what way do you recall having gained such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness in the past from here?”

byākāsī’ti. te añña-datthu mamaṃ yeva sāvakā sampajjanti, na cāhaṃ tesam. ahaṃ kho pana bhante, bhagavato sāvako sotāpanno avinipāta-dhammo niyato sambodhiparāyaṇo”ti.

“abhijānāsi no tvam devānaminda, ito pubbe evarūpaṃ veda paṭilābhaṃ somanassa-paṭilābhanti?”

“abhijānāmahaṃ bhante, ito pubbe evarūpaṃ vedapaṭilābhaṃ somanassa-paṭilābhanti.”

“yathākathaṃ pana tvam devānaminda, abhijānāsi ito pubbe evarūpaṃ vedapaṭilābhaṃ somanassa-paṭilābhanti?”

10. Once in the past, O Bhante, the devas and the asuras were arrayed for a battle. And in that battle, O Bhante, the devas were victorious and the asuras were defeated. Of me, O Bhante, having been victorious in that battle, as a victor in battle, this occurred: “Now, just that which is the food of the devas, and that which is the food of the asuras, the devas will enjoy them both.” But for me O Bhante, such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness in the sphere of violence, in the sphere of swords, does not lead to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowledge, to supreme awakening, to nibbana. But for me O Bhante, having heard this Dhamma of the Auspicious One, such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness not in the sphere of violence, not in the sphere of swords, leads

“bhūtapubbam bhante, devāsurasangāmo samupabyūlho ahoṣi. tasmim kho pana bhante, saṅgāme devā jiniṃsu, asurā parājīyimsu. tassa mayham bhante, tam saṅgāmaṃ abhivijitvā vijitasangāmassa etadahosi: ‘yā ceva dāni dibbā oḷā yā ca asurā oḷā ubhayamettha devā paribhuñjissantatī ti. so kho pana me bhante, vedapaṭilābho somanassapaṭilābho sandaḍḍāvacaro sasatthāvacaro na nibbidāya na virāgāya na nirodhāya na upasamāya na abhiññāya na sambodhāya na nibbānāya saṃvattatī. yo kho pana me ayam bhante, bhagavato dhammaṃ sutvā vedapaṭilābho somanassapaṭilā-

exclusively to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowledge, to supreme awakening, to nibbana,”

11. “But considering what benefit, do you, O Ruler of the devas, declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness?”

12. “Considering six benefits, O Bhante, do I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.”

“Remaining just here,
for me existing as a deva
being;
yet gained is renewed life
for me,
You should know thus,

bho, so adaṇḍāva-
caro asatthāvacaro
ekantanibbidāya vi-
rāgāya nirodhāya
upasamāya abhiñ-
ñāya sambodhāya
nibbānāya saṃvat-
tatī”ti.

“kiṃ pana tvam de-
vānaminda, atthava-
saṃ sampassamāno
evarūpaṃ vedapaṭi-
lābhaṃ somanassa
paṭilābhaṃ pave-
desī?”ti.

“cha kho ahaṃ bhante,
atthavase sampas-
samāno evarūpaṃ
vedapaṭilābhaṃ so-
manassapaṭilābhaṃ
pavedemī”ti.

“idheva tiṭṭhamānassa,
devabhūtaṃ me sato;
punarāyu ca me lad-
dho,

dear Sir.”

13. Seeing this first benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

Having passed from the deva group,
having abandoned the non-human life;
unconfused, I will enter a womb,
where my mind delights.

14. Seeing this second benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

That I, with unconfused wisdom,
dwelling delighting in the Instructions;
will dwell by the know-

evaṃ jānāhi mārīsā”ti.

imaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, paṭhamam atthava-
sam sampassamāno evarūpaṃ vedapa-
ṭilābham somanas-
sapaṭilābham pave-
demi.

cuto’haṃ diviyā kāyā,
āyum hitvā amānu-
sam;
amūlho gabbhames-
sāmi,
yattha me ramatī mano.

imaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, dutiyaṃ atthavasam
sampassamāno eva-
rūpaṃ vedapaṭilā-
bham somanassapa-
ṭilābham pavedemi.

svāhaṃ amūlhapañ-
ñassa,
viharam sāsane rato;
ñāyena viharissāmi,
sampajāno patissato.

how,
contemplative and mind-
ful.

15. Seeing this third benefit,
venerable sir, I declare such
an acquisition of feeling, an
acquisition of happiness.

And faring by the know-
how,
if there will be supreme
awakening;
I will dwell as one with
final knowledge,
and just that will be the
end.

16. Seeing this fourth ben-
efit, venerable sir, I declare
such an acquisition of feeling,
an acquisition of happiness.

Having passed away from
the human group,

imaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante,
tatiyaṃ atthavaśaṃ
sampaśsamāno eva-
rūpaṃ vedapaṭilā-
bhaṃ somanassa-pa-
ṭilābhaṃ pavedemi.

ñāyena me carato ca,
sambodhi ce bhavis-
sati;
aññathā viharissāmi,
sveva manto bhavis-
sati.

imaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante,
catutthaṃ atthava-
śaṃ sampaśsamāno
evārūpaṃ vedapa-
ṭilābhaṃ somanas-
sapaṭilābhaṃ pave-
demi.

cuto'haṃ mānusa
kāyā,

having abandoned the
human life;
I will again become a
deva,
in the highest deva world
[sudhāvāsa].

17. Seeing this fifth benefit,
venerable sir, I declare such
an acquisition of feeling, an
acquisition of happiness.

Those that are more sub-
lime than the devas,

the glorious Akaniṭṭha
[realm];
that will be my abode,
my final state of being.

18. Seeing this sixth benefit,
venerable sir, I declare such
an acquisition of feeling, an
acquisition of happiness.

āyum hitvāna mānu-
saṃ;
puna deva bhavis-
sāmi,
devalokamhi uttamo.

imaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante,
pañcamaṃ atthava-
saṃ sampassamāno
evarūpaṃ vedapa-
ṭilābhaṃ somanas-
sapaṭilābhaṃ pave-
demi.

te paṇītatarā devā,
akaniṭṭhā yasassino;
antime vattamānamhi,

so nivāso bhavissati.

imaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante,
chaṭṭhaṃ atthava-
saṃ sampassamāno
evarūpaṃ vedapa-
ṭilābhaṃ somanas-
sapaṭilābhaṃ pave-
demi.

19. Seeing these six benefits, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.
- ime kho ahaṃ bhante,
cha atthavase sam-
passamāno evarū-
paṃ vedapaṭilābhaṃ
somanassaapaṭilā-
bhaṃ pavedemi.

